
Culturally Responsive Diabetes Prevention & Management Program



WHAT IS IT THAT WE HOPE TO ADDRESS

Background



Racial and ethnic health disparities have been a public health crisis in the U.S. for decades. Despite national efforts like Healthy People and research such as the Institute of Medicine's report "Unequal Treatment" (2003), Black/African Americans continue to experience disproportionate rates of chronic conditions like obesity, hypertension, and diabetes. Diabetes, ranked as the 7th leading cause of death in the U.S., disproportionately impacts Black/African Americans, who have 2.5 times the rate of diabetes compared to white Americans and are twice as likely to die from diabetes complications. These disparities are linked to social determinants of health, including access to care, clinical guidance, and therapeutic use.

Purpose

This program aims to provide culturally responsive diabetes prevention and management education to Black/African American women in Hamilton County, Ohio. The centering model focuses on social cohesion, support, resources, and knowledge to address disparities in diabetes outcomes.



Overview



EXPECTED OUTCOMES

This project aligns with Healthy People 2030 priorities to reduce health disparities and address knowledge gaps for African American women in diabetes prevention and management.



TARGET OUTCOMES

Black women with private and public insurance who are pre-diabetic, recently diagnosed, or have uncontrolled diabetes.



KEY COLLABORATIONS

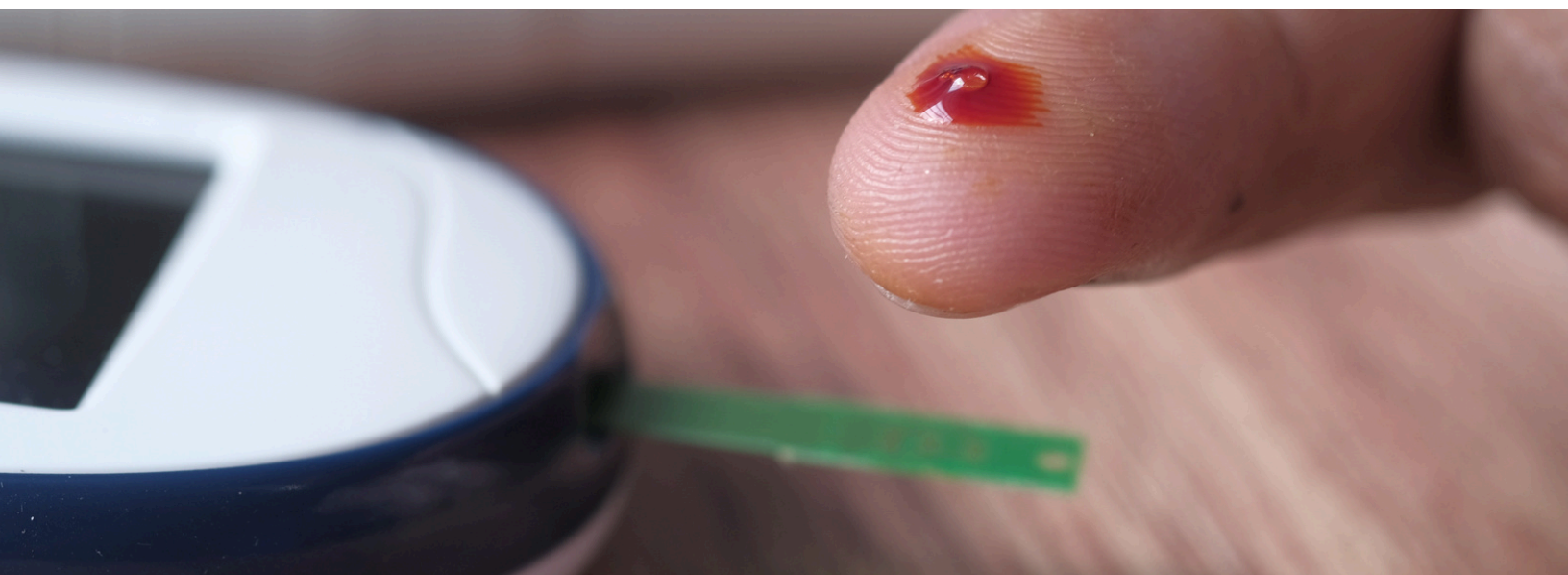
- Christ Hospital – Family Medicine Board
- Church Advent – Community engagement
- GCF (Grant-related work) – Community connections, grassroots food distribution
- UC Foundation – Community-driven programming
- Altev Pharmacy – Diabetes and community care logistics



PROGRAM STRUCTURE

1. Data Collection (during community care and meal prep) – Subjective & objective health data collection for provider assessments
2. Community Care (45 min) – Restorative elements
3. Meal Prep & Communal Dining (60 min)
4. Community Circle (45 min) – Knowledge sharing
5. Fitness & Closing Reflections (30 min) – Activities like dancing, yoga, strength training





Course Overview

Diabetes Basics	Managing Diabetes	Lifestyle Changes	BG (Blood Glucose) Tracking	Nutrition	Medication Types
What is diabetes?	Living with DM	Exercise/Steps	Tools (e.g., glucometers, apps)	Portions/serving sizes	Understanding when to escalate care
ABCs	Diabetes and You	Impact of diabetes on the heart, brain, kidneys, mental health	Staying on track	Planning and building a balanced meal	GLP1s
A - A1C	Sick day		Managing high BG	Meal planning & carb counting	Biguanides
B - Blood Pressure	Mental health		Preventing low BG	Reading food labels	Sulfonylureas
C - Cholesterol	Questions for doctors	Footcare	Checking your BG	Healthy eating	Glinides
Pathophysiology			Digital tools	Dining out	TZDs
Progressive nature					DPP4 inhibitors
Complications					Injectable non-insulin medicine
Types of DM					

CONTACT

POINT OF CONTACT?

MEET THE TEAM



DR. NICOLE D. AVANT

I am Dr. Nicole Avant, a passionate advocate for health equity, wellness, dignity, and structurally competent care, with a deep focus on cardiometabolic care and chronic disease management. My expertise spans ambulatory care, academia, health system consulting, and business development, enabling me to drive impactful change across clinical practice, employee wellness, and community health initiatives.

With a Bachelor of Science in Finance with Honors from the University of Illinois at Urbana-Champaign and a Doctor of Pharmacy, Magna Cum Laude, from the University of Illinois at Chicago, I have cultivated a career dedicated to improving health outcomes. My two pharmacy residencies deepened my expertise in patient-centered care and chronic disease management. As a former professor and Chief Diversity Officer, I have trained future healthcare leaders and championed structural competence in clinical practice. As a recognized researcher, author, and speaker, I have been honored for my work on implicit bias, microaggressions, and organizational culture transformation. I empower clinicians to provide equitable, patient-centered care, organizations to implement sustainable employee wellness strategies, and communities to access the resources needed for well-being..



DR. KNOX-KAZIMIERCZUK

Dr. Knox-Kazimierczuk, is an Assistant Professor in the Department of Rehabilitation, Exercise, & Nutrition Science at the University of Cincinnati. Dr. Knox-Kazimierczuk is a Registered Dietitian (RD) and Certified Athletic Trainer (ATC). Prior to her work in academia, Dr. Knox-Kazimierczuk worked in clinical and community dietetics for over fifteen years focusing on behavioral health nutrition and obesity, and worked in athletic training at the university and clinic setting for ten years. Dr. Knox-Kazimierczuk's research is centered in racial/ethnic health disparities, with an emphasis on birthing and breastfeeding disparities as well as cardiometabolic disease. Drawing on knowledge and experience from her interdisciplinary Ph.D. in Educational Leadership and Health Promotion with an emphasis in cultural studies from Miami University, Dr. Knox-Kazimierczuk works to address disparities through engaging and cultivating community assets to shift narratives, policies, and resources. This paradigm shift requires a thorough examination of societal structures which perpetuates power imbalances and scarcity in low resourced neighborhoods. Dr. Knox-Kazimierczuk has used her experience as an Interaction Institute for Social Change (IISC) Facilitator for Racial Justice and trained Qualified Administrator for the Intercultural Competence Development Inventory (IDI) along with her twelve years of experience facilitating Diversity, Equity, & Inclusion (DE&I) workshops to address inequities through educating other dietitians and healthcare providers and by working with policy makers for change.
